



The Quiet Vale

Seasons of Settlement

Production Rulebook v2.0

A game of stewardship, renewal, and hard choices after the old realm falls quiet.

Aligned Production Set: rules, components, map authority, and visual handoff are synchronized to v2.0.

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1. Game Overview

The Quiet Vale: Seasons of Settlement is a cooperative tile-laying and settlement-building game for 1-4 players. Players work together to guide a single shared settlement across three Seasons of five rounds each. Larger groups may use the Council Variant, which uses the 4-player rules engine and is not score-balanced.

The group succeeds by building Population, earning Renown, completing Steward's Ledger Achievements, welcoming Arrivals, and keeping Strain under control.

- Build and upgrade a shared settlement.
- Gather and spend shared resources from the Warehouse.
- Secretly seed hidden Encounter Cards into the Encounter Deck.
- Resolve Boons, Burdens, Arrivals, and the single Golden Boon.
- Unlock Special Tiles by completing Arrivals before they expire.
- Manage Strain before important tiles become Overstrained.

2. Components

Use the following component groups during play.

- Game Map
- Stewards Board
- Warehouse Board
- Round Timer token
- Resource markers: Wood, Stone, Metal, Food, Herbs, and Goods
- Encounter Cards: 25 Boons, 25 Burdens, 25 Arrivals, and Golden Boons
- Arrival timer tokens
- Strain tokens
- Supported tokens
- Core Tiles
- Special Tiles
- Steward Tokens
- Steward House Tiles
- Player Aids
- Steward's Ledger
- Action coins or equivalent markers for the 5+ Council Variant only

3. Setup

3.1 General Setup

1. Lay out the Game Map.
2. Place the Stewards Board and Warehouse Board nearby.
3. Place the Round Timer on Round 1.
4. Each player chooses a unique Steward Token and takes that Steward's Player Aid. Each player also takes that Steward's matching Steward House Tile, if Steward Houses are included in the component set.
5. Place the Steward's Ledger nearby.
6. Place resources, Strain tokens, Arrival timer tokens, Core Tiles, Special Tiles, and Golden Boons within reach.

3.2 Starting Warehouse Resources

Set the shared Warehouse to the starting resources for the player count before any player turns begin.

Players	1	2	3	4
Starting Warehouse	15 each	10 each	5 each	0 each

The 5+ Council Variant uses the 4-player rules and starts with 0 of each resource.

3.3 Starting Stewards and Resource Tiles

Each player places their Steward's matching starting Resource Tile for free on an empty map space with matching terrain. This ignores normal placement costs and adjacency requirements. Then place that player's Steward Token on that tile.

Steward	Starting Terrain	Starting Resource Tile
Vanguard	Woodland	Forest
Knight	Arable Land	Farm
Sentinel	Mountains	Mine
Ranger	Heaths	Wildlands
Warden	Ruins	Dig Site
Quartermaster	Any valid terrain	Any unused valid Resource Tile type

UNIQUE STEWARDS

Each named Steward is unique. The Quartermaster chooses any valid starting terrain and Resource Tile type not already used during setup.

3.4 Balanced Encounter Pool Setup

The standard game uses a balanced Encounter pool. Build the pool from separate Boon, Burden, and Arrival decks before dealing player hands and the Encounter Deck.

Players	Boons in Game Pool	Burdens in Game Pool	Arrivals in Game Pool	Standard Encounter Pool	Golden Boon	Hidden Cards per Player	Standard Cards to Encounter Deck
1	5	5	5	15	+1	10	5
2	10	10	10	30	+1	10 each	10
3	15	15	15	45	+1	10 each	15
4	20	20	20	60	+1	10 each	20

1. Shuffle the Boon deck and deal 5 Boons per player into the game pool.
2. Shuffle the Burden deck and deal 5 Burdens per player into the game pool.
3. Shuffle the Arrival deck and deal 5 Arrivals per player into the game pool.
4. Return unused standard Encounter Cards to the box face-down without revealing them.
5. Shuffle the game pool.
6. Deal 10 hidden Encounter Cards to each player.
7. Deal 5 standard Encounter Cards per player to the Encounter Deck on the Stewards Board.
8. Add exactly 1 random Golden Boon to the Encounter Deck and shuffle it.
9. Return all unused Golden Boons to the box.

NOTE

Golden Boons are handled separately and are never dealt to player hands.

3.5 Hidden Encounter Cards

In the standard 1-4 player game, player hands are hidden. Players should not discuss specific card names, exact effects, or precise seeding plans until those cards are revealed. General strategic discussion is allowed, but hidden-hand certainty should be preserved.

NOTE

Open-hand play is not part of the standard 1-4 player game. For larger groups, use the Council Variant in Section 17.

4. Core Concepts

4.1 Shared Settlement

All players build one shared settlement. Tiles placed by any player become part of the same settlement map. Resources, unlocked Special Tiles, active Encounters, Strain, Population, and Renown are shared by the group.

4.2 Seasons

Season	Rounds	Focus
Season I - Foundations	1-5	Resource production, early routes, and starting infrastructure
Season II - Growth	6-10	Population, Arrivals, travel expansion, industry, and community development
Season III - Maturity	11-15	Resilience, Renown, final refinement, and unresolved settlement pressure

4.3 Encounter Types

Encounter Type	Core Identity
Boon	A standard beneficial Encounter with Season-specific effects.
Burden	An ongoing negative Encounter that remains active until resolved or removed.
Arrival	A timed objective that unlocks a named Special Tile if completed.
Golden Boon	A distinct rule-breaking Encounter type. Exactly one appears each game.

5. Round Structure

Each round consists of four phases, resolved in order.

Phase	Name	Summary
1	Seed Encounter Cards	Each player with cards remaining in hand seeds 1 hidden Encounter Card anywhere into the Encounter Deck.
2	Reveal Encounters	Reveal standard Encounter Cards from the top of the Encounter Deck equal to player count. Golden Boons are extra reveals.
3	Player Turns	Each player takes one turn with 4 Actions. The group chooses turn order.
4	End of Round	Remove Arrival timers, expire failed Arrivals, discard applicable Boons, and advance the Round Timer.

5.1 Phase One - Seed Encounter Cards

Each player with Encounter Cards remaining in hand chooses 1 card from their hand and places it anywhere in the Encounter Deck. This is called seeding.

- Seeded cards remain face-down.
- Players may not inspect, count, reorder, or reveal cards already in the Encounter Deck unless a card effect explicitly allows it.
- If a player has no Encounter Cards in hand, that player does not seed a card this round.
- Golden Boons are never seeded by players.

5.2 Phase Two - Reveal Encounters

Player Count	Standard Encounter Cards Revealed per Round	Actions per Player
1	1	4
2	2	4
3	3	4
4	4	4

Reveal standard Encounter Cards from the top of the Encounter Deck equal to player count. Resolve each revealed card according to its Encounter type.

Golden Boon reveals exception: A Golden Boon does not count toward the number of standard Encounter Cards revealed for the round. When a Golden Boon is revealed, resolve it, then continue revealing Encounter Cards until the required number of standard Encounter Cards for the player count has been revealed.

5.3 Phase Three - Player Turns

During Phase Three, players choose which player takes the next turn. That player spends up to 4 Actions, then another player who has not acted this round is chosen. Each player takes one turn per round. A player may end their turn early; unused actions are lost and do not carry over.

5.4 Phase Four - End of Round

1. Remove 1 timer token from each active Arrival simultaneously.
2. After timer removal, any active Arrival with no timer tokens remaining and an unfulfilled Requirement expires and is discarded without unlocking its Reward.
3. Discard Boons from this round that are still face-up, unless their card text says otherwise. Boons that say "Keep this card face-up" remain face-up until their stated discard condition is met.
4. Resolve any other end-of-round effects.
5. Advance the Round Timer.

6. Player Actions

During their turn, a player spends actions one at a time. The same action may be taken multiple times if its requirements are met.

Action	Summary
Place a Tile	Place an available tile into an empty legal map space.
Upgrade a Tile	Flip a placed basic tile to its upgraded side.
Activate a Tile	Use a tile with an Activated Effect, including Resource Tile Production.
Interact with an Encounter Card	Complete an Arrival or resolve/interact with an active Burden on the Stewards Board.
Travel to a Disconnected Tile	Move beyond the connected settlement network, including unbridged river crossing or disconnected placement.

6.1 Place a Tile

Spend 1 Action to place an available tile into an empty legal map space.

- The map space must be empty.
- The terrain requirement must be met.
- Any adjacency or placement requirement must be met.

- Any listed resource cost must be paid from the Warehouse.
- At least one copy of that tile must remain available.
- The placement must follow Travel and Reachability rules, including any required Travel action for disconnected placement or unbridged river crossing.

6.2 Upgrade a Tile

Spend 1 Action and pay any listed upgrade cost to upgrade a tile. When a tile is upgraded, flip that tile to its upgraded side. It remains in the same map space and continues to count as the same placed tile.

- Upgrading is not placing a tile.
- A basic tile may be upgraded once.
- An upgraded tile cannot be upgraded again.
- Special Tiles enter with their full printed effect and cannot be upgraded.
- An Overstrained tile cannot be upgraded.

6.3 Activate a Tile

Spend 1 Action to activate a tile with an Activated Effect, if the acting player can reach that tile. Activating a tile provides its listed effect immediately.

- A tile may be activated multiple times each round by any players, as long as each activation spends a separate Action.
- Passive abilities do not require an Action.
- Overstrained tiles cannot be activated.
- If an Activated Effect affects another tile, only the activated tile must be reachable unless the effect says otherwise.

Production

Resource Tiles use the label Production. Production is an Activated Effect found on Resource Tiles. To use Production, activate that Resource Tile. The tile must be reachable and not Overstrained. Gain the listed resources into the Warehouse, up to the Warehouse limit.

6.4 Interact with an Encounter Card

Spend 1 Action to interact with an Encounter Card on the Stewards Board. Encounter Card interaction is position-independent:

- Use this action to complete an Arrival whose Requirement is fulfilled.
- Use this action when a Burden's To resolve line requires an action.
- If resolving an Encounter requires a normal map action, such as activating a tile, placing a tile, upgrading a tile, or removing Strain from a tile, that map action still follows normal map rules.

6.5 Travel to a Disconnected Tile

Spend 1 Action to move a Steward Token to a disconnected placed tile, across a river without a Bridge connection, or to an empty hex where that player is immediately placing a tile. This represents travelling beyond the connected settlement network.

**DISCONNECTED
PLACEMENT TIMING**

When placing a tile in an empty hex that is not connected to the acting Steward's current connected settlement network, spend the Travel action immediately before the Place a Tile action. If the tile cannot legally be placed, the Travel action cannot be taken for that hex. A hex across a river is disconnected unless a Bridge connects across that river.

7. Settlement Map and Tiles

7.1 Tile Categories

- Resource Tiles
- Housing Tiles
- Crafting Tiles
- Merchant Tiles
- Social Tiles
- Wellbeing Tiles
- Travel Tiles
- Special Tiles

7.2 Terrain and Adjacency

Many tiles have terrain requirements or adjacency requirements. A tile may only be placed if all printed placement requirements are met.

- Terrain requirements check the map space where the tile is being placed.
- Adjacency requirements are satisfied by sharing a hex side with the required tile, terrain, or feature.
- Overstrained tiles cannot satisfy placement adjacency requirements unless a rule or tile explicitly says otherwise.
- A tile may still be placed adjacent to an Overstrained tile if the placement is otherwise legal and does not rely on that Overstrained tile to satisfy a requirement.

7.3 Persistent Placement

- Players cannot voluntarily remove, abandon, clear, or replace a placed tile unless an explicit effect allows it.
- Placed tiles cannot be moved, replaced, or repositioned unless an explicit effect allows it.
- The only current core-game tile movement exception is a Golden Boon that allows tile movement. Follow that Golden Boon's exact text.

7.4 Multi-Hex Tiles

Some tiles occupy more than one hex. A multi-hex tile occupies every hex it covers. Each covered hex must be empty and legal. The tile may be rotated before placement. A multi-hex tile counts as one placed tile. If a multi-hex tile has a terrain requirement, at least one covered hex must match that terrain unless the tile says otherwise.

8. Travel and Reachability

8.1 Connected Settlement Network

All placed, non-Overstrained tiles connected by side adjacency form the connected settlement network. A tile contributes to this network while it is placed, not Overstrained, and not separated by a river or other barrier that lacks an explicit crossing rule.

8.2 Reachable Tiles

A Reachable Tile is one of the following:

- The tile occupied by the acting player's Steward Token.
- Any placed, non-Overstrained tile connected to that Steward's tile through the connected settlement network.
- Any tile or effect that a card or rule explicitly makes reachable, for example, the Stables or Docks.

Tile actions normally require the target tile to be reachable unless a rule explicitly says otherwise. Encounter Card interactions on the Stewards Board do not require reachability.

8.3 Rivers and Bridges

Rivers are barriers. Tiles on opposite sides of a river do not connect through adjacency unless a Bridge or another explicit rule permits that crossing. No tile may be placed on a river or water hex unless that tile specifically requires river or water terrain or explicitly permits river or water placement. A Bridge is the normal tile used to connect the settlement network across a river and may be placed on any River hex. Without a Bridge connection, crossing the river requires a Travel to a Disconnected Tile action.

8.4 Travel Tiles and Supported

Travel Tiles represent infrastructure such as paths, roads and bridges. Standard upgraded Travel Tiles again Supported. At 3 Strain, a Travel Tile is Overstrained and cannot provide Travel-specific benefits.

9. Resources and Warehouse

All resources are stored in the shared Warehouse. Players may freely spend shared resources during their turns.

Resource	Common Sources
Wood	Forests
Stone	Mines
Metal	Mines and Dig Sites
Food	Farms, Wildlands, and Forests
Herbs	Wildlands
Goods	Farms, Dig Sites, and Crafting

9.1 Warehouse Limit

The Warehouse can store a maximum of 15 of each resource type unless a rule explicitly changes this limit. When gaining resources, gain as much as possible up to the cap and lose any excess. Players may not voluntarily discard resources unless a rule says otherwise.

Cost reductions cannot reduce any cost below 0. If an effect reduces resources of your choice, choose resources that are actually present in that cost.

10. Encounter Cards

Encounter Cards represent opportunities, travelers, challenges, and lingering consequences from the old age. Encounter Cards are seeded into and revealed from the Encounter Deck.

10.1 Encounter Visibility

- Encounter Cards in player hands are hidden in the standard 1-4 player game.
- The Encounter discard pile is open information and may be inspected at any time.
- All Encounter Cards on the Stewards Board are open information, including active Arrivals, Completed Arrivals, and active Burdens.
- Players may not inspect, count, reorder, or reveal cards in the Encounter Deck unless a specific effect allows it.

10.2 Encounter Type Handling

Encounter Type	When Revealed
Boon	Resolve the current Season effect. If it modifies a later action or future event, keep it face-up according to its text.
Burden	Apply the current Season effect. Place the card on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
Arrival	Place it on the Stewards Board with 3 timer tokens. Players may complete it by fulfilling its Requirement and spending an Interact action.
Golden Boon	Resolve according to its unique Effect text and Golden Boon rules. It does not count toward the standard Encounter Cards revealed that round.

11. Arrivals and Special Tiles

11.1 Arrival Card Structure

- Card Name
- Arrival
- Flavour text
- Requirement: the condition players must fulfil, including the timer instruction: within three rounds. Place three tokens on this card to track.
- Reward: Unlock [Special Tile name]

11.2 Completing an Arrival

An active Arrival completes when a player spends 1 Action to interact with that Arrival while its Requirement is fulfilled.

- Requirement fulfilled means the Arrival is eligible to complete.
- The Interact with an Encounter Card action completes it.
- If the Requirement is not fulfilled, the Arrival cannot be completed.
- Arrival Requirements cannot be partially fulfilled.
- Arrivals do not use staged progress tracking.

11.3 Resource Requirements

If an Arrival Requirement asks players to pay resources, the full listed cost must be paid at once from the Warehouse as part of the Interact with an Encounter Card action. Players may not partially pay resources toward an Arrival.

11.4 Arrival Timer Effects

Some effects add timer tokens to active Arrivals. Completed Arrivals and expired Arrivals cannot gain timer tokens.

11.5 Completed Arrivals

When an Arrival is completed, remove any timer tokens from it and place its unlocked Special Tile on that Arrival card on the Stewards Board. That card becomes a Completed Arrival.

- A Completed Arrival is not an active Arrival.
- It does not lose timer tokens and cannot expire.
- It remains on the Stewards Board only as the holding place for its unlocked Special Tile.
- When the Special Tile is placed into the settlement, discard the Completed Arrival card.

If an Arrival unlocks multiple copies of a Special Tile, place all unlocked copies on that Completed Arrival card. Each copy may be placed later with a separate Place Tile action. Discard the Completed Arrival card after the last unlocked copy on it has been placed.

11.6 Expiring Arrivals

During Phase Four, after all active Arrivals lose 1 timer token, any active Arrival with no timer tokens remaining and an unfulfilled Requirement expires. Discard it without unlocking its Reward. Its associated Special Tile cannot be placed this game unless another rule explicitly unlocks it.

11.7 Unlocked Special Tiles

- When an Arrival reward says Unlock [Special Tile], place that Special Tile on the Completed Arrival card.
- Unlocked Special Tiles are communal. Any player may later place any unlocked Special Tile currently held on a Completed Arrival card.
- Placing an unlocked Special Tile requires a normal Place a Tile action.
- Special Tiles have no resource cost.
- The Special Tile must still satisfy its placement requirements.
- If no legal placement exists, the Special Tile remains on its Completed Arrival card.

11.8 Unplaced Special Tiles Are Inert

- An unlocked Special Tile on a Completed Arrival card is not part of the settlement map.
- It cannot receive Strain, cannot be Overstrained, and cannot be targeted by Burdens or other negative effects.
- It provides no active or passive effects until placed.
- It does not count for scoring, achievements, tile counts, adjacency, Travel, Population, Renown, or Arrival Requirements.
- Players are not required to place an unlocked Special Tile before the game ends.

12. Burdens

Burdens represent ongoing problems affecting the settlement. Burdens are ongoing negative Encounter Cards. There are no Immediate Burdens in the core game.

12.1 Burden Card Structure

- Card Name
- Burden
- Flavour text
- Season I: effect
- Season II: effect
- Season III: effect
- Place this card on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
- To resolve: cost or condition. Then discard this card. (Resolvable Burdens only)

Manageable Burdens omit the to resolve line and must instead be endured until the end of the game.

12.2 Applying Burdens

- When a Burden is revealed, apply the effect matching the current Season.
- After applying its effect, place it on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
- At the start of Round 6, each unresolved active Burden reapplies using its Season II effect.
- At the start of Round 11, each unresolved active Burden reapplies using its Season III effect.
- Reapplying a Burden is not a new Encounter reveal.

12.3 Burden Strain Targeting

When a Burden places Strain, follow its target instruction. A tile is a valid target if it matches that instruction and has fewer than 3 Strain. Overstrained tiles have 3 Strain and are not valid targets for Burdens that place Strain.

- If multiple valid targets exist, players collectively choose unless the Burden specifies otherwise.
- If no valid target exists, no Strain is placed for that application. The Burden remains active unless resolved or otherwise removed.
- Burden card text should use choose rather than target where possible, such as: Choose 1 Housing Tile with fewer than 3 Strain. Place 1 Strain on it.
- Disconnected or unreachable tiles may still be valid Burden targets unless the Burden specifically requires connection or reachability.

Numbered Burden Targets

When a Burden instructs players to choose a number of valid targets, choose that many if possible. If fewer valid targets exist, choose all valid targets. If no valid targets exist, no Strain is placed for that instruction.

Season III Fallback Targets

Printed Burden targets remain narrow in Seasons I and II. If they miss, they may still have no effect. In Season III only, the listed Burdens gain fallback targets if their printed Season III targets have no valid target. A fallback target must still have fewer than 3 Strain. If the fallback also has no valid target, no Strain is placed for that application.

- Smoke over Hearths: if no valid Housing Tile adjacent to a Crafting target exists, choose 1 Crafting Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Wares of War: if no valid Housing Tile adjacent to a Merchant target exists, choose 1 Merchant Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- The Long Cough: if no valid Housing Tile adjacent to a Social target exists, choose 1 Social Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Coin Before Craft: if no valid Merchant/Crafting adjacency target exists, choose 1 Merchant Tile or Crafting Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Old Trenches Return: if no valid Travel Tile adjacent to a Resource target exists, choose 1 Resource Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Omen of Discontent: if no valid Travel Tile adjacent to a strained Housing target exists, choose 1 Travel Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Empty Shelves: if no valid Social Tile target exists, choose 1 Housing Tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Promises Overstretched: if there are no active Arrivals in Season III, choose 1 placed tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.
- Welcome Wears Thin: if there are no active Arrivals in Season III, choose 1 placed tile with fewer than 3 Strain and place 1 Strain on it instead.

12.4 Resolving Burdens

- Effects that remove a Burden use the wording Resolve 1 active Burden.
- Resolving an active Burden removes it from the Stewards Board and discards it unless the effect says otherwise.
- A resolved Burden is no longer active, does not reapply at future Season starts, and does not count against final scoring.
- Resolve 1 active Burden can remove any active Burden, including a Manageable Burden or a Burden with no current valid target/effect.
- Resolving a Burden does not remove Strain already placed by that Burden.

Season-Scaled Resolution Costs

Resolvable Burdens use Season-scaled resolution costs. A Burden revealed or reapplied later is usually harder to endure and more expensive to resolve. This is intentional: delaying a Burden through seeding can protect the settlement short-term, but makes that Burden more costly when it appears later.

Season III-Only Burden Resolution

Some Burdens are not resolvable through their own card text in Seasons I and II but gain this resolution line in Season III only: In Season III, to resolve: Spend 1 Action and pay 4 Goods. Then discard this card.

- Apply this Season III-only resolution to Smoke over Hearths, Wares of War, The Long Cough, Coin Before Craft, Old Trenches Return, Omen of Discontent, Bare Walls, Empty Shelves, Storehouses Disagree, and Promises Overstretched.
- This resolution is available only during Season III. Effects that resolve any active Burden can still resolve these Burdens normally if the resolving effect allows it.

13. Boons and Golden Boons

13.1 Standard Boons

Standard Boons provide immediate benefits and moments of good fortune. They use Season I, Season II, and Season III effect fields.

- When a Boon is revealed, apply the effect matching the current Season.
- Boon effects are optional unless the Boon specifically says otherwise.
- Only one Boon may modify a single action. If multiple could apply, players choose one.
- A Boon may affect multiple actions only if its text explicitly says so.
- Most Boons resolve immediately and are discarded after resolving.
- Boon effects that affect the next or first eligible action normally remain visible until used, then are discarded immediately. If unused, discard them in Phase Four unless the card says to keep it face-up across rounds.
- A Boon that says Keep this card face-up remains face-up until its stated discard condition is met, even across rounds, unless the card says otherwise.

Boon Persistence Clarifications

Keep other Boons round-limited unless their existing text already makes them persistent.

- The Apprentice Steward stays face-up until the next qualifying tile placement, then is discarded after use. It affects Action cost only, not resource cost.
- Roads Filled Again stays face-up until the next qualifying Travel Tile placement or Travel Tile upgrade, then is discarded after use.
- A Little Time stays face-up until it can add timer token(s) to an active Arrival, then is discarded after use.

13.2 Golden Boons

Golden Boons are a distinct Encounter type. They are not standard Boons. Each game includes exactly one Golden Boon, always inserted into the Encounter Deck during setup.

- Golden Boons do not use Season I, Season II, or Season III fields.
- Golden Boons use a bespoke Effect field.
- Golden Boons may break normal game rules in specific ways. When a Golden Boon conflicts with the normal rules, its text takes precedence for that effect only.
- A Golden Boon does not create a general rule change beyond the exception printed on that card.
- Resolve each Golden Boon according to its card text.
- Golden Boon phase exceptions: If a Golden Boon grants an additional Player Turns phase, resolve only that additional Player Turns phase. Do not seed or reveal Encounter Cards, remove Arrival timers, resolve Phase Four, or advance the Round Timer unless the Golden Boon explicitly says otherwise.

13.3 Golden Boon Taxonomy

- A reference to Encounter Card includes Golden Boons unless explicitly excluded.
- A reference to Boon means standard Boon only unless it says Golden Boon or any Boon.
- A Golden Boon in the Encounter Deck is revealed through the normal Encounter reveal step.
- A revealed Golden Boon does not count toward the number of standard Encounter Cards revealed for the round. Resolve it, then continue revealing until the correct number of standard Encounter Cards has been revealed.

14. Strain, Supported, and Overstrained

14.1 Strain

Strain represents pressure on the settlement: physical damage, social exhaustion, emotional wounds, failing infrastructure, or unstable resources. When Strain is applied, place Strain tokens as instructed.

- A tile cannot have more than 3 Strain.
- Apply as much Strain as possible up to the cap of 3. Ignore excess unless an effect says otherwise.
- Tiles with 1 or 2 Strain still function normally unless an effect says otherwise.

14.2 Supported

Supported is a persistent binary status. A tile either has Supported or it does not. Multiple instances do not stack.

- At the start of each round, each Supported tile refreshes.
- Supported prevents the first Strain token applied to that tile each round.
- Supported may prevent Strain from any source if it has not already prevented Strain that round.
- Supported tokens remain for the game unless a rule removes them.
- Overstrained disables Supported but does not remove it. If the tile later drops below 3 Strain, Supported functions again.

Some passive effects cause tiles to have Supported while a condition is true. These effects do not place permanent Supported tokens. If the passive effect stops applying, the affected tiles no longer have Supported from that source.

14.3 Overstrained

A tile with 3 Strain is Overstrained. Overstrained is the game's single disabled-tile state.

- Overstrained tiles cannot be activated or upgraded.
- Overstrained tiles provide no passive effects.
- Overstrained tiles do not contribute to the connected settlement network and do not provide Travel-specific connectivity or benefits.
- Overstrained tiles do not contribute Population or Renown.
- Overstrained tiles do not satisfy placement, upgrade, Arrival, Achievement, or positive scoring requirements unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.
- Overstrained tiles remain on the map and do not return to supply.
- Overstrained tiles retain their Strain tokens. Those Strain tokens count for final Strain penalties.

14.4 Recovering from Overstrained

As soon as a tile has fewer than 3 Strain, it is no longer Overstrained. Its effects, scoring contribution, connectivity, and Supported status resume immediately, subject to normal timing restrictions.

15. Seasons and Final Scoring

15.1 End of Season Effects

A Season ends after Rounds 5, 10, and 15. At the end of the final round of each Season, apply that Season's end effect.

Season End	Timing	Effect
End of Season I	After Round 5	Add up to 10 assorted resources to the Warehouse. The 15-per-type Warehouse limit still applies.
End of Season II	After Round 10	Each Overstrained tile spreads 1 Strain to an adjacent tile, following normal Strain cap and prevention rules.
End of Season III	After Round 15	Apply final Renown penalties: -6 Renown for each active Burden and -2 Renown for each Strain token on the board.

15.2 Final Settlement Score

At the end of Season III, apply the End Score Adjustment, then total the settlement's Population and Renown.

1. Count Population from eligible non-Overstrained tiles only.
2. Count Renown from eligible non-Overstrained tiles and effects.
3. Subtract 6 Renown for each active Burden.
4. Subtract 2 Renown for each Strain token on the board.
5. Compare the final combined Population + Renown total against the group's success threshold.

16. Steward's Ledger

The Steward's Ledger records Achievements and gives each settlement a legacy. Achievements encourage varied strategies, unusual layouts, specialised districts, efficient growth, and high-resilience settlements.

- Overstrained tiles do not count toward Achievements unless the Achievement explicitly says otherwise.
- Unlocked but unplaced Special Tiles do not count toward Achievements.

17. Variants

17.1 Council Variant - 5+ Players

The standard game is designed for 1-4 players. For 5 or more players, use the Council Variant. This is a large-table cooperative mode that uses the 4-player rules engine. It is not score-balanced, and final scoring and Steward's Ledger Achievements are not supported.

Area	Council Variant Rule
Player count	5+ players
Rules engine	Use 4-player standard setup and pacing
Council seats	4 council seats
Hands	Deal 4 open council hands of 10 Encounter Cards each
Initial Encounter Deck	Deal 20 standard Encounter Cards to the Encounter Deck
Golden Boon	Add 1 Golden Boon to the Encounter Deck
Seeding	Each round, seed 1 card from each council hand with cards remaining
Reveal rate	Reveal 4 standard Encounter Cards per round
Actions	Use 16 shared Action coins each round
Turn structure	No individual player turns; the council spends shared actions
Visibility	Council hands are open information
Scoring and Achievements	Not supported
Starting Warehouse	0 of each resource, matching the 4-player setup.

Council Variant Encounter Pool

Because the Council Variant uses the 4-player engine, build a 60-card standard Encounter pool: 20 Boons, 20 Burdens, and 20 Arrivals. Deal four open council hands of 10 cards, deal 20 standard Encounter Cards to the Encounter Deck, then add 1 Golden Boon. The Council Variant starts with 0 of each resource in the Warehouse.

Action Coins

At the start of each Player Turns phase, place 16 Action coins in the action pool. Each time the council takes an action, spend 1 Action coin. When no Action coins remain, the Player Turns phase ends.

Steward Powers in Council Variant

In the Council Variant, a Steward Power may be used when the council spends an action through that Steward, or when that Steward is the acting Steward for the relevant action. Each Steward Power remains usable once per Season.

17.2 Artist Mode

Artist Mode is a relaxed solo variant focused on creating a settlement rather than scoring. Scoring and Achievements are not used. You may select and place Special Tiles without their normal unlock requirements, following the variant's chosen action cost and any placement restrictions you wish to preserve.

18. Glossary

Term	Definition
Active Arrival	An Arrival on the Stewards Board with timer tokens whose Requirement has not yet been fulfilled.
Active Burden	A Burden on the Stewards Board that has not been resolved or otherwise removed.
Activated Effect	A tile effect used by spending an Activate a Tile action. The activated tile must be reachable and not Overstrained unless a rule says otherwise.
Boon	A standard Encounter type that resolves a Season-specific benefit. Golden Boons are not standard Boons.
Burden	An ongoing negative Encounter type that applies Season-specific pressure and remains active until resolved or removed.
Completed Arrival	An Arrival whose Requirement has been fulfilled and whose unlocked Special Tile has not yet been placed. It is not active.
Encounter Card	A card of one Encounter type: Boon, Burden, Arrival, or Golden Boon.
Golden Boon	A distinct Encounter type. Exactly one is used per game. It may break normal rules in card-specific ways.
Internal Role Tag	A production/development label used for organisation. It has no rules meaning unless printed rules text explicitly says otherwise.
Multi-Hex Tile	A tile that occupies more than one hex. It counts as one placed tile and must cover empty, legal hexes when placed.
Overstrained	A tile with 3 Strain. It is inactive for functional checks and positive settlement value.
Passive	A non-action effect that applies while its condition is true. Passive effects stop applying while the tile is Overstrained unless a rule says otherwise.
Production	The resource-generating Activated Effect found on Resource Tiles.
Reachable Tile	A tile the acting Steward can use from their current position through the connected settlement network, unless a rule says otherwise.
Special Tile	A tile unlocked through an Arrival. It has no resource cost by default and is placed later with a Place Tile action.
Steward Power	A limited-use effect on an upgraded Steward House. It is not an Activated Effect and does not require activating the tile.
Supported	A persistent status that prevents the first Strain token applied to a tile each round.
Warehouse	The shared resource store for all players.
Connected Settlement Network	All placed, non-Overstrained tiles connected by side adjacency, excluding blocked river crossings or other barriers unless an explicit rule connects across them.
River Barrier	A river or water feature that blocks normal adjacency for connectivity. Crossing normally requires a Bridge or a Travel to a Disconnected Tile action.
Travel Tile	A tile category representing movement infrastructure, river crossing, support, separated-cluster connection, resilience, or scoring. Travel Tiles are no longer the only tiles that carry reachability.

Appendix A. Standard Card Structures

A.1 Standard Boon

- Card Name
- Boon
- Flavour text
- Season I: [effect]
- Season II: [effect]
- Season III: [effect]

A.2 Burden

- Card Name

- Burden
- Flavour text
- Season I: [effect]
- Season II: [effect]
- Season III: [effect]
- Place this card on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
- To resolve: [cost/condition]. Then discard this card. (Resolvable Burdens only)

A.3 Arrival

- Card Name
- Arrival
- Flavour text
- Requirement: [condition] within three rounds. Place three tokens on this card to track.
- Reward: Unlock [Special Tile name].

A.4 Golden Boon

- Card Name
- Golden Boon
- Flavour text
- Effect: [unique Golden Boon effect]
- Golden Boon card text may break normal game rules for that effect only.

Appendix B. Setup Reference Tables

B.1 Starting Warehouse Resources

Use this table during setup after placing the Warehouse Board and before the first round begins.

Players	Starting Warehouse
1	15 of each resource
2	10 of each resource
3	5 of each resource
4	0 of each resource
5+ Council Variant	0 of each resource

B.2 Standard Game Setup Summary

Players	Game Pool	Hands	Encounter Deck	Reveal per Round	Actions per Player
1	5 Boons / 5 Burdens / 5 Arrivals	10 hidden cards	5 standard cards + 1 Golden Boon	1 standard card	4
2	10 Boons / 10 Burdens / 10 Arrivals	10 hidden cards each	10 standard cards + 1 Golden Boon	2 standard cards	4
3	15 Boons / 15 Burdens / 15 Arrivals	10 hidden cards each	15 standard cards + 1 Golden Boon	3 standard cards	4
4	20 Boons / 20 Burdens / 20 Arrivals	10 hidden cards each	20 standard cards + 1 Golden Boon	4 standard cards	4

B.3 Council Variant Summary

Players	Council Hands	Encounter Deck	Reveal per Round	Actions
5+	4 open hands of 10 cards	20 standard cards + 1 Golden Boon	4 standard cards	16 shared Action coins

Appendix C. Default Map Reference

C.1 Map Identity and Coordinate System

Field	Value
Map name	Redesigned Basic Map v0.2
Default status	Default locked map. Redesigned Basic Map v0.1 is historical / previous-reference only.
Map geometry	Flat-top hex map, 14 columns by 9 rows.
Columns	A-N horizontally from left to right.
Rows	1-9 vertically from top to bottom.
Coordinate format	ColumnLetter + RowNumber, e.g. A1, B1, N9.
Total hexes	126

C.2 Terrain Counts

Terrain	Count
Grasslands	75
Water/River	21
Woodland	6
Mountains	6
Heaths	6
Arable Land	6
Ruins	6
Total	126

C.3 Water/River Coordinates

Water/River	Water/River	Water/River
D1	D2	E3
F3	E4	G4
H4	E5	I5
J5	E6	K6
L6	E7	L7
E8	F8	M8
N8	G9	H9

Every Water/River hex remains a legal potential Bridge placement site. Do not restore fixed Bridge Candidate markers.

C.4 Ruins Coordinates

Ruins	Ruins	Ruins
F4	F5	G5
J9	K9	L9

C.5 Changes from Redesigned Basic Map v0.1

Coordinate	Previous Terrain	v0.2 Terrain
K7	Water/River	Grasslands
L6	Grasslands	Water/River
I9	Ruins	Grasslands
K9	Grasslands	Ruins
M9	Ruins	Grasslands
L9	Grasslands	Ruins
N9	Ruins	Grasslands